We wear sweaters and use shawls and blankets in the winter. Many of these are not made from natural wool although they appear to resemble wool. These are prepared from another type of synthetic fibre called acrylic. The wool obtained from natural sources is quite expensive, where as clothes made from acrylic are relatively cheap because they are a byproduct of the production of plastics. They are available in a variety of colours. Synthetic fibres are more durable and affordable which has contributed to their widespread use.





ACTIVITY 3

Identify The Fibre : Let us do an activity. Look at the images below and identify and write down the name of the different types of fibre observed.



Jute



Cotton



Silk saree



Rayon material



Wool



Polyester

ACTIVITY 4

Synthetic or Natural Fibres : The teacher can give the learner a piece of each and every type of fibre. The learner can feel the fibre and write down the name of the fibre and state whether it is natural or synthetic fibre.

S.No	Name of the fibre	Type of the fibre– Natural /Synthetic

We have done four activities so far. Which activity helped you better to identify the type of fibre? ……..... (Both the use of familiar images as well as touch can help us to identify the different types of fibres. Right!) We have learned about fabrics such as polyester, nylon and acrylic and their common uses. These synthetic fibres are polymers which we will learn about later in this chapter.

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